

WEEK 3 · AWS · FINOPS

FinOps is not a tool. It is a discipline.

Visibility, accountability, optimisation and continuous review. What each one means, and how to make it a habit.

INSIDE

Contents

What FinOps really means, the four parts that make it work, who does what, and how to start in your first month.

Introduction 03

01 The four parts 05

02 Myths and roles 10

03 Your first month 12

INTRODUCTION

Spending with intent, not just spending less.

FinOps is how engineering, finance and the business work together so that every pound of cloud spend is seen, owned and deliberate. It is less about a product you install and more about how your teams behave.



It starts with seeing

Clear, shared data on what is being spent, where and why.



It works through ownership

Teams who build and run services also own what those services cost.



It lasts through habit

A regular rhythm of review keeps decisions fresh as the estate changes.



FinOps is not a project with an end date. It is a habit your teams keep.

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01

PART 01

Four parts, one cycle.

Each part supports the next. Skip one and the cycle stalls.

01 Visibility

02 Accountability

03 Optimisation

04 Continuous review

01



Visibility

See where every pound goes, in terms the business understands.

WHAT IT MEANS

Cost data that is timely, trusted and broken down by team, product and environment.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Anyone can answer what a service costs and why it changed, without a spreadsheet hunt.

FIRST STEP

Agree a tagging standard and switch on cost allocation tags.

WATCH OUT FOR

Dashboards nobody opens. Visibility only counts if it is used.

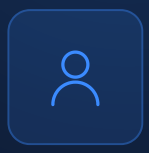


OWNER

Finance and platform team together

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

02



Accountability

Every cost has a named owner who can explain it and act on it.

WHAT IT MEANS

The people who build and run a service also own what it costs.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Owners see their own spend, and expect to be asked about it.

FIRST STEP

Map each account, product or tag to one accountable owner.

WATCH OUT FOR

Shared costs with no owner. Split them, or name a single owner.



OWNER

Product and engineering leads

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

03



Optimisation

Spend with intent: right size, right pricing model, right time.

WHAT IT MEANS

Rightsizing, scheduling, clearing waste and matching commitments to steady use.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

Savings come from regular, small decisions rather than an annual panic.

FIRST STEP

Act on the clearest recommendations in Compute Optimizer and schedule non-production.

WATCH OUT FOR

Cutting what supports revenue. Optimise for value, not just for less.



OWNER

Engineering, with finance input

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

04



Continuous review

Check, adjust and repeat, on a rhythm everyone knows.

WHAT IT MEANS

A regular review of spend, anomalies, commitments and actions.

WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE

A short monthly meeting with owners, and alerts that catch surprises between them.

FIRST STEP

Set AWS Budgets and Cost Anomaly Detection, then book a monthly review.

WATCH OUT FOR

Reviews that report but never decide. End each one with owned actions.



OWNER

A named FinOps lead

Bring this to the monthly review, with a date for each action.

MYTH VS REALITY

What FinOps is not

Four common misunderstandings that stop FinOps before it starts.

	MYTH	REALITY
Tooling	FinOps is a tool you buy.	It is a discipline your teams practise. Tools help, habits deliver.
Goal	FinOps means cutting cost.	It means spending with intent, which sometimes means spending more.
Ownership	Finance owns it.	Engineering, finance and the business share it.
Timeline	It is a one-off project.	It is a continuous cycle of review and improvement.
Who starts	You need a big team first.	One named lead and a monthly review is enough to begin.

WHO DOES WHAT

Shared work, clear roles

FinOps works when each group knows its part and meets the others regularly.



Engineering

Designs and runs services with cost in mind. Owns rightsizing, scheduling and clean-up.



Finance

Owns budgets, forecasts and commitments. Turns cost data into planning.



Business leaders

Set priorities and decide what is worth spending on.



FinOps lead

Runs the rhythm: data, reviews, actions and follow-up.

> **If you only do one thing, name the FinOps lead. Everything else follows from someone owning the rhythm.**

GETTING STARTED

Your first month of FinOps

A simple sequence that gets the cycle turning without a big programme.

Week one: see it

Turn on cost allocation tags, agree a tagging standard and build one shared view of spend.

Week two: own it

Name an owner for each account or product, and share their spend with them.

Week three: act on it

Take the clearest optimisation actions: schedule non-production, clear orphaned storage.

Week four: review it

Hold the first monthly review. Agree actions, owners and the next date.

> **Next month, repeat. That is the discipline.**

TRANSPUTEC

Not a project.
A habit.

We help teams set up the rhythm, the data and the ownership that make FinOps stick.

Talk to us about FinOps

transputec.com